

Evergreen School

Creativity Program Year Overview

August 2026 to April 2027

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The Framework

All four sessions are anchored in the five creativity mindsets, drawn from the Creative Habits model developed by the Center for Real-World Learning at the University of Winchester:

1. **Imaginative** (using intuition, making connections, playing with possibilities),
2. **Inquisitive** (wondering and questioning, exploring and investigating, challenging assumptions),
3. **Persistent** (daring to be different, tolerating uncertainty, sticking with difficulty),
4. **Collaborative** (sharing the product, giving and receiving feedback, co-operating appropriately),
5. **Disciplined** (developing techniques, reflecting critically, crafting and improving).

Each session uses one mindset in its facilitation, so faculty experience the mindset before they are asked to teach through it. Workshop 1 in April used inquisitive, which means all five are covered across the full arc.

The Year-End Deliverable

By April, each teacher will have designed, delivered, and reflected on **two lessons representing two different mindsets**. The first is built in September from a lesson that is already working well. The second is built in October from a lesson that isn't. Teachers may not use the same mindset twice.

Session One: September 2nd and 3rd (Cyndi and Matt on site)

Topic: Amplifying what is already working.

Mindset used: Collaborative

Teachers arrive having pre-identified a lesson from the past year where they and their students were learning at their best, with detail on what they were doing, what students were doing, and what made it work.

The sequence: Picasso in a Bag group collaboration, then appreciative inquiry in trios where teachers share their peak teaching and learning experience from last year, then an overview of the five mindsets, then reflection back on their own story to see which mindset stood out, then a deliberate redesign that amplifies that mindset in the lesson. Teachers submit the amplified lesson on Thursday afternoon.

The collaborative mindset is used throughout: teachers co-operate in trios, give and receive feedback on each other's lessons, and share the product by submitting it to the group library.

Learning outcome: As a result of this session, educators will be able to identify the mindset most present in a lesson they already teach well, and deliberately redesign that lesson to amplify it.

Session 2: October 8th and 9th (Cyndi on site)

Topic: Redesigning what isn't working.

Mindset used: Imaginative, using divergent and convergent techniques

Teachers bring a lesson they don't enjoy teaching, or that consistently falls flat with students. Working in trios, they diagnose what is going wrong, generate a wide range of possibilities using divergent thinking, converge on the strongest direction, and redesign the lesson around a second mindset different from their September choice. Before leaving, each teacher confirms when in the calendar that lesson actually occurs, so implementation is realistic ahead of January.

Learning outcome: As a result of this session, educators will be able to apply divergent and convergent thinking to redesign an underperforming lesson around a second mindset.

Session 3: January 5th (Matt on site)

Topic: How do you know it worked?

Mindset used: Persistent

By this session, teachers should have delivered at least one and ideally both lessons. The focus shifts from design to evidence: what did you actually observe in student learning, what surprised you, what fell apart, and how would you tell someone else about it? Persistence is the right mindset for this session because it is where teachers sit with what didn't work, tolerate the uncertainty of a lesson that only half landed, and stick with it rather than abandoning it. This session also provides dedicated work time to package both examples for April, which matters because faculty have limited time outside these sessions.

Learning outcome: After this session, educators will be able to evaluate evidence from a delivered lesson and articulate what they observed in student thinking and learning.

Session 4: April (Cyndi and Matt on site)

Topic: Teacher Innovation Showcase.

Mindset used: Disciplined

Teachers present both lessons across two different mindsets. The emphasis is on the honest arc of the year, including what did not work, and on building a shared library of real classroom examples that future cohorts and colleagues can draw from. The disciplined mindset shows up in crafting and improving the final artifacts, critically reflecting on the year, and sharing finished work with the wider faculty.

Learning outcome: As a result of this session, educators will be able to present two delivered lessons representing two different mindsets, communicating what they tried, what they observed, and what they would change.